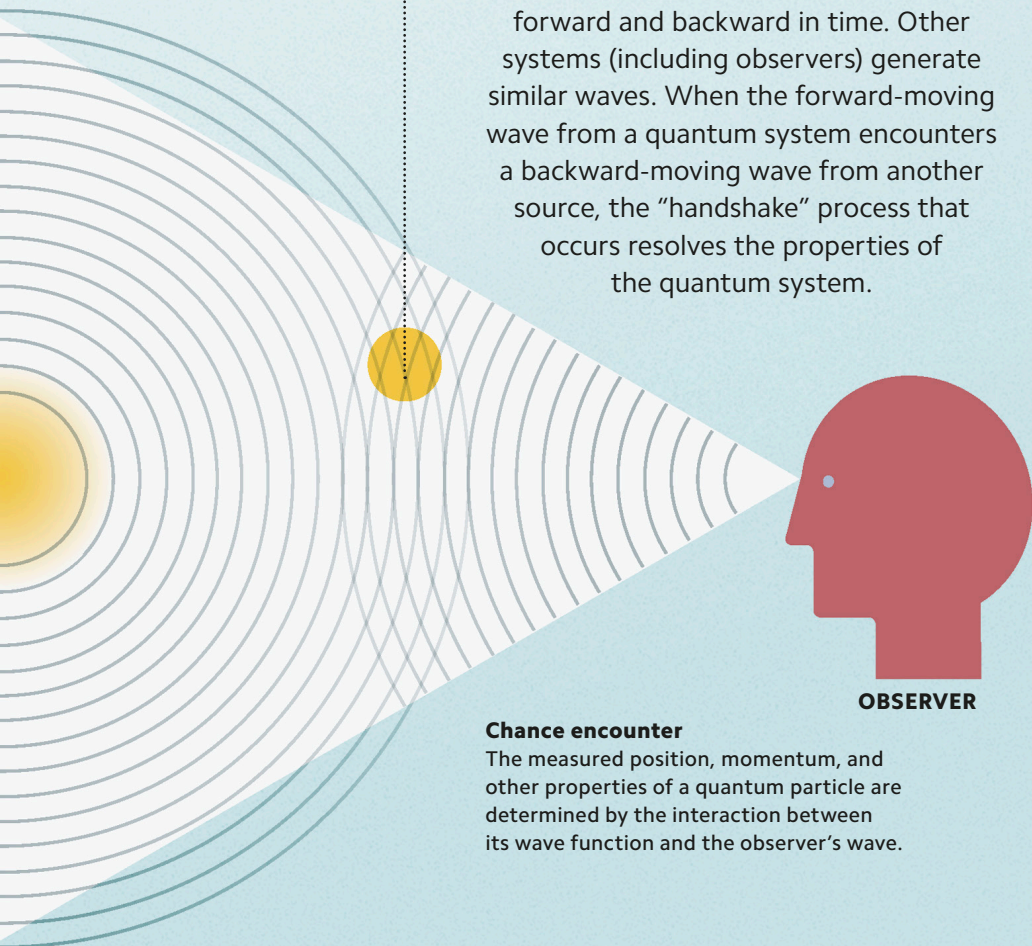


Interference between waves moving forward and backward in time produces an appearance of instantaneous wave-function collapse.

WHERE THE
WAVES MEET

A QUANTUM HANDSHAKE

The transactional interpretation offers a possible explanation for the way that interactions between quantum systems actually take place. It suggests that the wave function generates waves that move out into the surroundings and both forward and backward in time. Other systems (including observers) generate similar waves. When the forward-moving wave from a quantum system encounters a backward-moving wave from another source, the “handshake” process that occurs resolves the properties of the quantum system.



Chance encounter

The measured position, momentum, and other properties of a quantum particle are determined by the interaction between its wave function and the observer's wave.